Feral animals – Cats

Feral cats are found in all areas of Australia. They spend most of the day hiding and sleeping, and hunt at night. Feral cats don't drink much water, as they get moisture from the animals they kill. They kill birds, small mammals, reptiles and frogs. Some larger cats will even kill animals the size of a possum. Feral cats hunt many **native species** and ground-nesting birds. Scientists believe they have hunted many species of small desert animals to **extinction**. Bilby, numbat and mala populations have all been seriously affected by the feral cat population.

Feral cats breed throughout the year and have few **predators**, except dingoes and eagles. They are hard to control because they don't take baits and are shy of traps. They avoid humans and so are hard to shoot.

☞ **1** In your own words, write four important ideas about feral cats.

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2 Are these statements true or false?

a) Feral cats sleep during the night. _____

b) Feral cats only eat small mammals. _____

c) Bilby populations are threatened by feral cats. _____

d) Feral cats are producers. _____

e) Feral cats are at the bottom of the food chain. _____

3 List any other feral animals you can think of.

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